Zicheng Zhu

I am interested in **AI for human mental well-being**, especially **social well-being**. Specifically, I am interested in the following questions: How does AI affect humans' mental well-being and their social connections with others? How can AI be designed and governed to better support human mental well-being and social engagement?

zicheng-zhu.com
zicheng@u.nus.edu
Google Scholar
LinkedIn

Employment

Starting 2026/11
Kyoto, Japan

Kyoto University
Assistant Professor
School of Informatics

2023/11 - 2026/09
Singapore

National University of Singapore
Research Fellow
School of Computing
Mentor: Yi-Chieh Lee

Education

2019 - 2024
Singapore

National University of Singapore
PhD in Communications and New Media
Advisors: Renwen Zhang, Alex Mitchell
Committee: Weiyu Zhang, Hichang Cho
Dissertation: Digital Wellbeing in Gaming: an Examination Through Technological and Contextual Lenses

2017 - 2019
Boston, USA

Boston University
MSc in Marketing Communication Research

2013 - 2017
Guangzhou, China

Sun Yat-sen University
BA in Internet and New Media

Publications

CSCW 2026

Shared Similarity Between Humans and Chatbots: Exploring Human Willingness to Seek Social Support From Chatbots
Zicheng Zhu, Tianqi Song, Jefferson Lim, Chi-Lan Yang, Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction
Paper

UIST 2026

ASIDE: From Conflict Participants to Co-Observers Through Dyadic Spectator Reflection
Xinyi Zhang, Jingting He, **Zicheng Zhu***, and Yuxin Su
Proceedings of the ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology
Preprint * Corresponding author

CSCW 2026 **Alleviating Linguistic and Interactional Anxiety of Non-Native Speakers in Multilingual Communication**
Peinuan Qin, Justin Peng, Zhengtao Xu, Jiting Cheng, **Zicheng Zhu**, Naomi Yamashita, Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction
Paper

DIS 2026 **Designing with Tensions: Older Adults' Emotional Support-Seeking Under System-Level Constraints in Conversational AI**
Mengqi Shi, Tianqi Song, **Zicheng Zhu**, Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of Designing Interactive Systems
Paper

CHI 2026 **ChatLearn: Leveraging Non-Native Speaker Communication Challenges as Language Learning Opportunities**
Peinuan Qin, Yugin Tan, Jingzhu Chen, Nattapat Boonprakong, **Zicheng Zhu**, Naomi Yamashita, Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper

CHI 2026 **AI-exhibited Personality Traits Can Shape Human Self-concept through Conversations**
Jingshu Li, Tianqi Song, Nattapat Boonprakong, **Zicheng Zhu**, Yitian Yang, and Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper Best Paper Honorable Mention

CHI 2025 **The Benefits of Prosociality towards AI Agents: Examining the Effects of Helping AI Agents on Human Well-Being**
Zicheng Zhu, Yugin Tan, Naomi Yamashita, Yi-Chieh Lee, and Renwen Zhang
Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper Best Paper

CHI 2025 **Mining Evidence about Your Symptoms: Mitigating Availability Bias in Online Self-Diagnosis**
Junti Zhang, **Zicheng Zhu**, Jingshu Li, and Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper

CSCW 2025 **Multi-Agents are Social Groups: Investigating Social Influence of Multiple Agents in Human-Agent Interactions**
Tianqi Song, Yugin Tan, **Zicheng Zhu**, Yibin Feng, and Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction
Paper Methods Recognitions

CSCW 2025 **Exploring the Effects of Chatbot Anthropomorphism and Human Empathy on Human Prosocial Behavior Toward Chatbots**
Jingshu Li, **Zicheng Zhu**, Renwen Zhang, and Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction
Paper

CSCW 2025 **AI-Based Speaking Assistant: Supporting Non-Native Speakers' Speaking in Real-Time Multilingual Communication**
Peinuan Qin, **Zicheng Zhu**, Naomi Yamashita, Yitian Yang, Keita Suga, and Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction
Paper

Telemat. Inform. 2025

Contextual Influences and Agency to Transform Context in Excessive Gaming: A Social-Ecological Perspective
Zicheng Zhu, Renwen Zhang, and Alex Mitchell
Telematics and Informatics
Paper

Cyberpsychol Behav Soc Netw 2025

Understanding Problematic Gaming Through Self-Determined vs. Non Self-Determined Motivation: Two Mediating Pathways of Harmonious and Obsessive Passion
Wenjing Pan, Jikai Sun, **Zicheng Zhu**, Renwen Zhang, and Xiaoning Han
Cyberpsychology, Behavior, and Social Networking
Paper

JMIR 2023

Examining the Persuasive Effects of Health Communication in Short Videos: Systematic Review
Zicheng Zhu, Shiyu Liu, and Renwen Zhang
Journal of Medical Internet Research
Paper

JCMC 2022

Toxicity and Prosocial Behaviors in Massively Multiplayer Online Games: The Role of Mutual Dependence, Power, and Passion
Zicheng Zhu, Renwen Zhang, and Yuren Qin
Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication
Paper

DIS 2022

Developing Intentional Relationships With Technologies: An Exploratory Study of Players' Experiences With Built-in Interventions in Games
Zicheng Zhu, Alex Mitchell, and Renwen Zhang
Proceedings of Designing Interactive Systems
Paper

Extended Abstracts

CHI 2026

When Humans Don't Feel Like an Option: Contextual Factors That Shape When Older Adults Turn to Conversational AI for Emotional Support
Mengqi Shi, Tianqi Song, **Zicheng Zhu**, and Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the CHI Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper

CHI 2026

InterPilot: Exploring the Design Space of AI-assisted Job Interview Support for HR Professionals
Zhengtao Xu, Zimo Xia, **Zicheng Zhu**, Nattapat Boonprakong, Yu-An Chen, Rabih Zbib, Mr. Casimiro Pio Carrino, Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the CHI Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper

CHI 2026

ConvScale: Conversational Interviews for Scale-Aligned Measurement
Peinuan Qin, Jingzhu Chen, Yitian Yang, Han Meng, **Zicheng Zhu**, Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the CHI Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper

CHI 2026

"Clumsiness is Love Itself": How Long-Distance Couples Experience, Envision, and Resist AI in Intimate Relationships
Xinyi Zhang, **Zicheng Zhu***, Yuxin Su
Proceedings of the CHI Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper * Corresponding author

CHI 2025 **Greater than the Sum of its Parts: Exploring Social Influence of Multi-Agents**
Tianqi Song, Yugin Tan, **Zicheng Zhu**, Yibin Feng, and Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the CHI Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper

CHI 2025 **AI Literacy Education for Older Adults: Motivations, Challenges and Preferences**
Eugene Tang KangJie, Tianqi Song, **Zicheng Zhu**, Jingshu Li, and Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the CHI Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper

CHI 2025 **Humans Help Conversational AI: Exploring the Impact of Perceived AI Deservingness on People's Decisions to Help and Their Perceptions on AI Seeking Help**
Yu-An Chen, **Zicheng Zhu**, and Yi-Chieh Lee
Proceedings of the CHI Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper

CHI 2022 **Developing Intentional Relationships with Technologies: Exploring Players' Tension between Play and Non-play and Designing Built-in Interventions to Contribute to Digital Well-Being**
Zicheng Zhu
Proceedings of the CHI Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems
Paper

Conference Presentations (Non-archival)

AAAI 2026 **Multi-Agents are Social Groups: Investigating Social Influence of Multiple Agents in Human-Agent Interactions**
Tianqi Song, Yugin Tan, **Zicheng Zhu**, Yibin Feng, and Yi-Chieh Lee
The Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence Workshop
Oral Best Paper Award

ICLR 2025 **The More, The Stronger? Investigating How Multi-Agent AI Shapes Human Opinions**
Tianqi Song, Yugin Tan, **Zicheng Zhu**, Maojia Song, Feng Yibin, and Yi-Chieh Lee
International Conference on Learning Representations Workshop
Spotlight

ICA 2025 **Multi-Agents are Social Groups: Investigating Social Influence of Multiple Agents in Human-Agent Interactions**
Tianqi Song, Yugin Tan, **Zicheng Zhu**, Yibin Feng, and Yi-Chieh Lee
International Communication Association Conference
Top Paper Award

ICA 2025 **Exploring the Effects of Chatbot Anthropomorphism and Human Empathy on Human Prosocial Behavior Toward Chatbots**
Jingshu Li, **Zicheng Zhu**, Renwen Zhang, and Yi-Chieh Lee
International Communication Association Conference

ICA 2023 **When Will I Stop My In-Progress Game? Understanding the Role of Game Accomplishment, Multiple-Goal Pursuits, and Strain in Gameplay Disengagement**
Zicheng Zhu, Renwen Zhang, Mitchell Alex, and Zhuo Chen
International Communication Association Pre-Conference

ICA 2023 **Persuasive Effects of Health Messages in Short Videos: A Systematic Review of Literature**
Zicheng Zhu, Shiyu Liu, and Renwen Zhang
International Communication Association Conference

ICA 2023 **Combating Contextual Problematic Gaming Through Context Transformation**
Zicheng Zhu, Renwen Zhang, and Alex Mitchell
International Communication Association Conference

ICA 2022 **Prosocial and Toxic Behaviors in Massively Multiplayer Online Games: The Role of Perceived Interdependence and Passion**
Zicheng Zhu, Renwen Zhang, and Yuren Qin
International Communication Association Conference

Honors and Awards

2026 Best Paper Honorable Mention Award (ACM CHI, top 5%)

2026 Oral (AAAI Workshop)

2025 Best Paper Award (ACM CHI, top 1%)

2025 Methods Recognitions (CSCW)

2025 Spotlight (ICLR HAIC Workshop)

2025 Top Paper Award (ICA)

2021 Graduate Students' Teaching Award (Honour Roll)

2021 Graduate Students' Teaching Award

2020 Graduate Students' Teaching Award

Grants and Fellowships

2023 International Association of Cultural and Creative Industry Research Funding ($10,000)

2022 Graduate Research Support Scheme (S$3,000)

2022 Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (S$2,000)

2019 Graduate Teaching Fellowship

2017 Boston University Scholarship ($15,000)

2017 School of Communication and Design Elite Development Scholarship

2015 School of Communication and Design Scholarship

2015 University of Technology Sydney Cheung Kong Scholarship (A$5,000)

Teaching Assistant

2022 Fall - 2023 Spring **NM2103: Quantitative Research Methods**
Department of Communications and New Media, National University of Singapore

2020 Spring - 2021 Fall **NM3217: Principles of Communication Design**
Department of Communications and New Media, National University of Singapore

2019 Fall **NM3234: Leadership, Organisations and New Media**
Department of Communications and New Media, National University of Singapore

Professional Service

Conference Chair
International Conference on Human-Engaged Computing (ICHEC)
NUS-Google Workshop: Future of CS Education and Curriculum in the AI Era

Conference Committee
2027 The ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
2026 The ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS)
2024 The ACM Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW)

Conference Reviewer
ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
The ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST)
The ACM Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW)
International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)
ACM SIGCHI Annual Symposium on Computer-Human Interaction in Play (CHI PLAY)
International Communication Association Conference

Journal Reviewer
New Media & Society
ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI)
Cyberpsychology, Behavior, and Social Networking
International Journal of Health Communication
Mobile Media & Communication

University Service

2023 **Summer Institute in Computational Social Science in Singapore**
Organizer

2021 - 2022 **Graduate Student Representative**
Department of Communications and New Media, National University of Singapore

2021 **Global Forum of Computational Social Science**
Organizer

2021 **Books Week of Department of Communications and New Media**
Organizer

2021 **Communications and New Media Graduate Student Conference**
Organizer

Work Experience

2022 Singapore **Centre for Trusted Internet and Community, National University of Singapore**
Research Assistant
Project: Digital Well-being Indicator Framework
PI: Dr. Audrey Yue

2018 Guangzhou, China **NetEase Games**
Management Trainee

2018 Remote **Pulitzer Center**
Translator

2016 — Hunan, China
Hunan Broadcasting System
Director

2014 — Shenzhen, China
Shenzhen Evening News
Journalist

Mentees (Non-advisees)

2025
Zimo Xia
Centre for Data Science and Machine Learning, National University of Singapore
The Influence of AI Clone on Its Owner
Paper submitted to CHI 2026

2024
Ann Chen
Yale-NUS College
The Influence of Humans Providing Help to AI
Paper submitted to International Journal of Human-Computer Studies

2024
Yuanxin Ma
School of Computing, National University of Singapore
The Influence of AI Representative on the Social Perception of Its Owner
Mentored undergraduate thesis

2024
Jefferson Lim
School of Computing, National University of Singapore
The Influence of Similarity on Help Seeking from Chatbots
Paper accepted to CSCW 2026

2024
Charles Loy
Yale-NUS College
The Influence of AI Gender on Decision Making
Mentored undergraduate thesis

Skills

Languages: JavaScript, C#, Python, R

References

Dr. Yi-Chieh Lee, Assistant Professor
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Dr. Renwen Zhang, Assistant Professor
Wee Kim Wee School of Communication and Information
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Dr. Alex Mitchell, Associate Professor
Department of Communications and New Media
National University of Singapore
alexm@nus.edu.sg
narrativeandplay.org/~alex/

Dr. Naomi Yamashita, Professor
Graduate School of Informatics
Kyoto University
naomiy@acm.org

Dr. Chi-Lan Yang, Associate Professor
Institute of Library, Information and Media Science
University of Tsukuba
chilanyang@slis.tsukuba.ac.jp
chilanyang.space